

Text Response Framework

IT SAYS...

IT MEANS...

IT MATTERS...

A tool for *understanding what you read* and *writing an academic response*.

IT SAYS...

The Washington Post
Local

Holding parents accountable: Grades? Fines? Jail?

By Valerie Strauss June 8, 2011

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This was written by Catherine Durkin Robinson, a nationally syndicated writer and the founder/president of National Coalition for Accountable Parenting. She lives in Tampa.

The organization is focused on encouraging a national discussion about the importance of effective parenting and empowering the public to hold parents accountable.

Just how much say the public should have in the way people parent is a controversial issue, especially now, amid increasing calls for schools to find ways to hold parents accountable for their involvement in their children's education. Is there any way to do this fairly? It is something schools should be doing in any case? Robinson thinks so. Do you?

By Catherine Durkin Robinson

Legislators, groups, and school officials across the country are trying to change No Child Left Behind and make the law, along with our schools and education in general, much better. They stress the importance of teachers, administrators, and community leaders, and bemoan our students' lack of knowledge when compared to the rest of the world.

Why don't they mention parents in this equation?

In Maryland, some parents have been jailed for failing to bring their kids to school. Parents in Alaska can be fined up to \$500 for every five unexcused absences, and California passed a law allowing them to prosecute, fine, and jail parents in similar situations.

THIS MEANS...

Parents are getting consequences in Maryland, Alaska, and California when their students don't come to school regularly.



THEY SAY...

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THIS MATTERS...

This matters to the argument NOT because it is pro or con, but because it shows the urgency in the current situation. We cannot ignore the issue. I am not sure of my stance yet, but whatever it is, I will want my audience to understand the seriousness